

Module 3



Group and Team Dynamics : Composition, Formation-Problem Solving in Groups - Group vs Team, Team Dynamics - Managing team performance
Leadership : Leadership Framework - Types of Leadership - VUCA
Leadership - Transactional vs Transformational Leaders

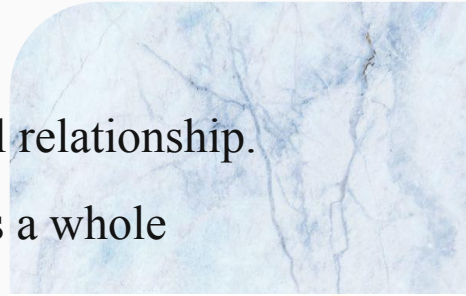


Groups

- Group is a collection of individuals connected by and within a social relationship.
- Group members interact with one another and also with the group as a whole
- For the existence of a group there is a purpose.
- Ex: members of a political party, family members..

Characteristics of a group

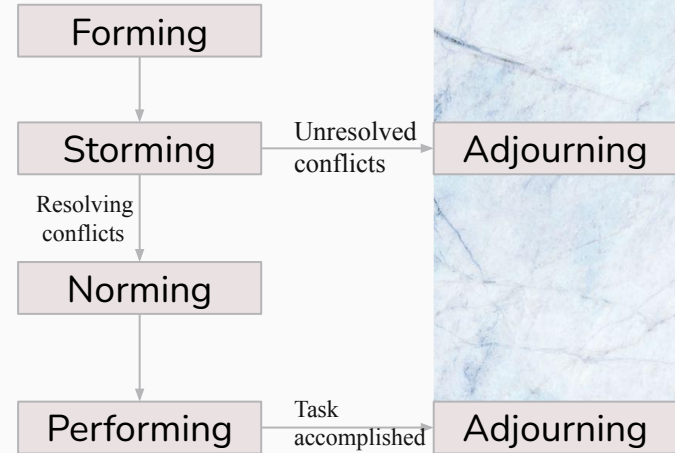
- Frequent interactions
- Interdependence and mutual influence
- Common objectives, common beliefs & common expectations
- Cohesiveness and unity



Stages of group formation

- Well known theory : - Tuckman and Jensen theory -5 stages of group formation

1. Forming
2. Storming
3. Norming
4. Performing
5. Adjourning



Stages of group formation

Forming

Team acquaints and establishes ground rules. Formalities are preserved and members are treated as strangers.



Storming

Members start to communicate their feelings but still view themselves as individuals rather than part of the team. They resist control by group leaders and show hostility.



Norming

People feel part of the team and realize that they can achieve work if they accept other viewpoints.



Performing

The team works in an open and trusting atmosphere where flexibility is the key and hierarchy is of little importance.

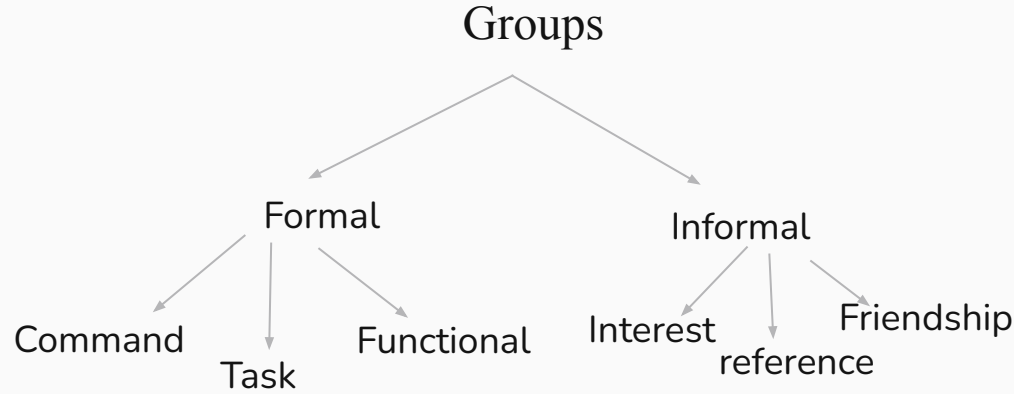


Adjourning

The team conducts an assessment of the year and implements a plan for transitioning roles and recognizing members' contributions.



Types of group



- **Formal groups** : created & maintained consciously and deliberately to achieve certain common objectives
 - large in size and are usually established by an organization
 - directions & channels of communication, hierarchy & structure will be pre-defined
 - rules are framed with a view to ensure rationality and efficiency

- ***Informal groups*** → formed naturally in response to social and psychological needs of people.

- formed based on common interests, shared values, prejudices etc
- no hierarchy and every members form informal groups.
- exists a personal relationships between members of an informal group
- May have unwritten rules and unspoken norms.

Group thinking

- Group thinking is a psychological phenomenon that occurs within a group of people in which the desire for harmony or conformity in the group results in an irrational or dysfunctional decision making.
- Group members try to minimize conflict and reach a consensus by actively suppressing dissenting viewpoints and by isolating themselves from outside influences, without critical evaluation of alternative viewpoints.
- Group thinking requires individuals to avoid raising controversial issues or alternative solutions, and there is loss of individual creativity, uniqueness and independent thinking.

Clarifying expectations

- Expectation is a feeling or belief about how good someone or something would turn out to be.
- It includes how a person will behave, how things are going to happen, what is going to be the result, etc. it is necessary to avoid expecting high, as over expectation leads to disappointment if things will not happen as per the expectations.
- While forming a group, the members should be clarified about the possible outcomes and expectations, to avoid disappointment.
- Leaders of the group should spend some time for this.
- The objectives of the group are to be made clear to the new members.

Group problem solving

Steps in group problem solving

1. Define
2. Analyze
3. Set criteria for solution
4. Evaluate all possible solutions
5. Evaluate and select the best solution
6. Implement



Define

- There should not be any ambiguity regarding the task at hand
- Team leader must be able to summarize the problem in a single sentence

Analyze the problem

Following points can be discussed by team members

- Is it true that the problem exists?
- What are the reliable indicators?
- How grave is the problem?
- What are the root causes of the problem ?
- Have there been previous attempts to solve the problem?

- Do we have sufficient data to generate the solution?
- What is the deadline for the solution?
- Do we have enough experts among us?

Set criteria for solution

Some criteria can be

- Solution should be workable
- Solution should be economical
- Solution should address the cause of the problem
- Solution should not bring with it undesirable side effects



Generate all possible solutions

- Basically a brain-storming session in which all team members are to come up with solutions that could solve the problem.
- Solutions are not evaluated at this point
- Other members can ask questions and clarify the various aspects without being prejudiced or judgemental
- Focus is to generate as many solutions as possible
- Ideas, even wild ones, are to be voiced freely without reservation.
- Should continue till the group runs out of ideas.

Evaluate and select the best solution

- Each solution is critically evaluated for its merit and completeness
- Evaluate each potential solution based on the criteria
- The following questions can be helpful
 - what is the exact nature of each solution?
 - is it possible to implement this with our current resources and work force?
 - Is it economical in the long run?
 - does the solution address the root cause of the problem?
 - how well does it meet our criteria?
 - Will this solution bring undesirable side effects? If so, is it possible to avoid them?
 - would a combination of solutions work best?

Implement

Includes the following steps

- Decide on the modus operandi
- Allot individual task to team members based on their expertise / strengths
- If necessary and possible, delegate tasks to people outside the group
- Decide on how to assess the effectiveness of the solution or “how do we know if the problem is solved or not?”
- Decide on a time frame
- Execute

Group v/s Team

The difference between group and team in the workplace can be drawn clearly on the following grounds:

- There is only one head in a group.
- A team can have more than one head.
- The group members do not share responsibility, but team members share the responsibility.
- The group focuses on achieving the individual goals.
- Conversely, the team members focus on achieving the team goals.
- The group produces individual work products.

- As opposed to, the team who produces collective work products.
- The process of a group is to discuss the problem, then decide and finally delegate the tasks to individual members.
- On the other hand, a team discusses the problem, then decide the way of solving it and finally do it collectively.
- The group members are independent. Unlike a group, the team members are interdependent

GROUP

TEAM

1	Individual contributions	Synergic contribution
2	Random skills	Complementary skills
3	Works towards common goal	Total commitment to common goals
4	Little sense of ownership among members because they are not much involved in planning the goals	Great sense of ownership because the members have helped in establishing the common goals
5	Little scope for creativity	Opportunity for creativity
6	Individual responsibility	Collective responsibility
7	Diverse culture	Shared culture
8	Shared interest	Mutually agreed interest
9	Conflicts are common	Lesser chance for conflicts
10	Accountable to group leader	Mutual accountability
11	More focus on individual rewards	More focus on shared rewards
12	Less interdependence	High interdependence
13	Leader controls the group	Leader acts as facilitator
14	Lesser coordination, lesser task orientation and lesser collaboration	Greater coordination, task orientation and better collaboration
15	Lesser familiarity among members	Greater familiarity among members
16	Limited awareness about the skills and tasks of other members	Greater awareness about the roles, weaknesses and strengths of other members
17	Cautious approach and limited trust	Candid approach and higher level of trust
18	Lesser chances of appreciating others' efforts	Greater appreciation from team members
19	More concerned with challenges faced by the individual	More concerned with challenges faced by the team
20	Roles and tasks are often fixed	Roles and tasks are rotated as and when required
21	Members think that they are brought together for administrative convenience	Members are aware that individual goals are best achieved through mutual support and working towards team goals

Group Dynamics

- Group dynamics refers to the complex interplay of various interactive forces between members of a group.
- It influences the attitude of members of a group, group performance and its long time survival.
- It can be synonymously called as group processes.
- Some group process techniques are:

Brainstorming

- Process for generating creative ideas and solutions through intensive and freewheeling group discussion.
- Every participant is encouraged to think aloud and suggest as many ideas as possible, no matter seemingly how outlandish or bizarre.
- Analysis, discussion, or criticism of the aired ideas is allowed only when the brainstorming session is over and evaluation session begins.

Multi-voting

- Multi voting is a fast method to select the most relevant and popular ideas from a list with the least difficulty and least chances of conflict.
- The steps involved in multi voting are,

- Number each idea
- Combine similar items if the group agrees and renumber them
- Each member votes multiple times and his ideas will be written on a paper
- Lists are collected and consolidated
- Ideas with maximum votes are identified.
- Repeat the procedure after a discussion. Stop after reaching an agreement.

Nominal group techniques (NGT)

NGT involves the following steps

- Moderator states and clarifies the problem
- Each member thinks independently about the problem and silently writes his ideas on a paper

- Moderator asks for ideas and writes those on a board to make them visible to the others in the group.
- Each recorded idea will be evaluated
- Each member votes for 5 ideas the he thinks the best
- The moderator adds scores of the votes.
- The ideas that are ranked high are chosen.

Decision grid

- In this method, options are listed as rows and factors to be considered as columns.
- Scores are given for each option/ factor and scores are added.
- We can understand the relative importance of each factor.

- If there are numerous factors to be considered, the decision grid will be given on pair wise i.e. only two alternatives will be given from which a single solution is given as voting



Team

- Team is a small group of individuals working together to achieve a specific, common goal.
- Not all small groups operate as teams
- Members of a team usually have complementary skills and therefore, a high degree of interdependence.
- Ex: Football team
- Team also develop through the five stages:
 1. Forming
 2. Storming
 3. Norming
 4. Performing
 5. Adjourning

Types of Teams

1. ***Problem solving teams*** : focus on a specific issue, usually these teams are disbanded once the object is achieved.
2. ***Self-managed team*** : members are empowered to make informed decisions, each team member usually has a unique skill set.
3. ***Functional teams*** : people are brought together by similar function
ex: a team to handle advertisement through visual media
Members will have more or less same skill set & skills are combined to achieve more efficiency

4. ***Cross-functional teams*** : people with different functional expertise are brought together to form a team.

ex: objective is to launch a new product, people from finance, technical, marketing etc are brought together to form a cross-functional team

5. ***Virtual teams*** : members are distributed across several geographic locations.

Communication between the team members will be digital rather than in person

Team dynamics

- Team dynamics are the unconscious, psychological forces that influence the direction of behavior and performance of a team.
- Team dynamics are created by the nature of the work of the team, the personalities within the team and their working relationships with other people and the environment in which the team works.
- Team dynamics can be good when they improve overall team performance and get the best out of individual team members.
- They can also be bad when they cause unproductive conflict, demotivation and prevent the team from achieving its goals.

Team composition

Depending on the attributes of the individual team members, teams can be of

Homogenous composition : team members share almost the same attributes such as skill, intellect, education, personal and demographic traits

Heterogeneous composition : one in which individual members have widely different attributes.

Characteristics of Homogenous team

- Better initial rapport
- Easiness of communication
- Lesser conflicts
- Paucity of ideas
- Liable to get stuck

Characteristics of Heterogenous team

- Initial conflicts
- Difficulty in communicating
- Different perspectives
- More creativity
- Productive in the long run



Team Performance Management (TPM)

- The continuous process of evaluating the effectiveness of the team and varying and adjusting the different factors that have a bearing on team performance.
- Performance of a team is directly related to both individual performance and how the individual contributes as part of a team
- TPM refers to following an ongoing and well structured process specifically targeted to identify, quantify and modify the factors that affect performance

Team Performance Management (TPM) cycle

The Performance Management Cycle

Step 1: Planning

Setting SMART goals and defining metrics.

Step 2: Monitoring

Track progress, check in regularly, and address obstacles.

Step 3: Reviewing

Review goal completion and evaluate end-results.

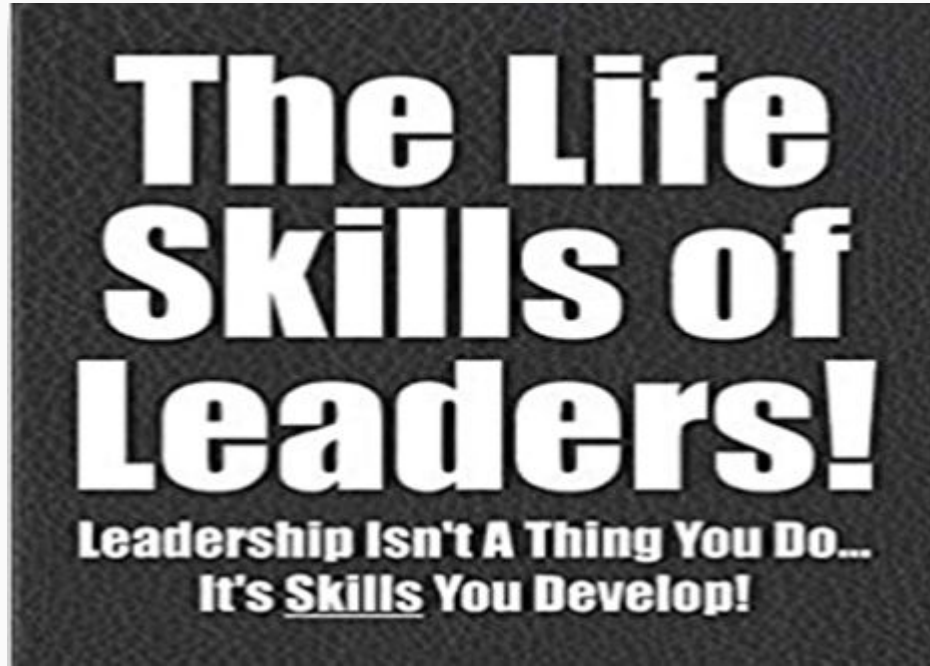
Step 4: Rewarding

Celebrate success. Provide high-performers with rewards & recognition.





- Leadership is the ability to lead or guide people towards the accomplishment of a common goal.
- A leader is one who knows the way, goes the way and shows the way. – *John C Maxwell*



Leadership involves:

Vision

Ability to convince others

Ability to inspire others

Providing knowledge and strategy

Coordinating and guiding *Balancing the*

interests of everyone *Being resilient at*

times of crises

Framework for analyzing leadership

3 elements : Leader, Follower, Situation

Leader : the traits of the leader, his expertise and his societal/organizational positions are the key factors.

Followers : The shared values, norms and extent of bonding between the followers influence how they perform as a group and how they respond to their leader

Situation : Nature of the goal to be attained, the level of stress, the stakes and the general environment make each situation unique. The interaction between leader and followers depend largely on the situation



VUCA Leadership :

- VUCA is acronym for *Volatility*, *Uncertainty*, *Complexity* and *Ambiguity*.
- It was coined by the US Army to describe the world after the Cold War.

VUCA Means :

- *Volatility* - A high rate of change
- *Uncertainty* - Lack of clarity about the present and the future
- *Complexity* - Multiple factors impacting key decisions
- *Ambiguity* - Lack of clarity about meaning and events

Volatility

- If the situation is volatile, it means things are changing too fast.
- A leader who takes decisions about stable situations only may feel it difficult to take decisions when a sudden change happens.
- A good leader should have the capacity to take decisions even in adverse situations.

Uncertainty

- In this situation, the leader is uncertain of his actions and their consequences.
- This happens due to imperfect or insufficient data.

Complexity

- It is the condition in which the leader faces multiple factors, each one autonomous and interdependent.
- Such situations results in stagnation of judgement.
- Decision making will be difficult.

Ambiguity

- If a situation has more than one interpretations, that will result in ambiguity.
- Ambiguity is a situation in which a difficulty to explain will exist due to multiplicity.

In a VUCA world, the leaders need

- 1) Learning agility
- 2) Intellect to deal with complexity
- 3) Values for guidance though uncertainty
- 4) Emotions to relate to others
- 5) Drive for relentless pursuit of goals.



Leadership Types :

Type of leadership	Features	Pros	Cons	Example
Autocratic	Leader makes all decisions, team follows orders	Quick decisions, clear control	Team feels ignored, low creativity	Military commander
Democratic	Leader involves team in decision-making	Encourages teamwork, new ideas	Time-consuming	Teacher involving students in planning
Laissez-faire	Leader gives freedom to team members	Promotes creativity, independence	Can cause confusion, lack of direction	Research guide letting students explore
Transactional	Based on rewards & punishments	Good for short-term goals, discipline	Limits innovation, motivation depends on rewards	Sales manager giving bonuses

Leadership Types :

Type of leadership	Features	Pros	Cons	Example
Transformational	Inspires with vision & motivation	Builds enthusiasm, long-term growth	Risky if vision fails	Startup founder motivating employees
Servant	Focus on serving team's needs	Builds trust, develops people	May be seen as too soft	Manager prioritizing employee growth
Bureaucratic	Strictly follows rules & procedures	Ensures order, safety	Blocks innovation, rigid	Government official
Charismatic	Leader attracts with personality & charm	Inspires loyalty, strong motivation	Too dependent on leader's presence	Popular political leader

Transactional Leaders v/s Transformational Leaders

Transactional Leadership	Transformational Leadership
✓ Suitable for a settled environment where efficiency is improved.	✓ Suitable during troubled times where innovation and changed are needed.
✓ Works well when the emotional level of the employees is not high.	✓ It appeals to the emotions of the employees
✓ Formal and bureaucratic.	✓ Informal and charismatic.
✓ Only one leader will be there.	✓ There can be more than one leader.
✓ Employs planning and execution to maintain status quo.	✓ Stimulates and promotes innovation.
✓ Employs rewards and punishments using authority and position.	✓ Employs influence and intellectual stimulation using charisma.
✓ Reactive	✓ Proactive